



THE WHITE NILE AND SUDD CENTRE



Condolence Message and Tribute on the passing of Hon. Uncle Bona Malwal Madut Ring

November 3, 2025

On behalf of the Board of Trustees (BOT) of The White Nile and Sudd Center (WNSC) and its general membership and followers, alongside all those who value the long and difficult journey toward the freedom and dignity of the people of South Sudan, we learn with profound sadness the passing on of Hon. Bona Malwal Madut Ring, an iconic towering political figure in South Sudan. We whole-heartedly extend our deepest condolences to his family, relatives, and friends.

Born in the late 1920s and trained as a journalist and economist in the Sudan, the United States, and the United Kingdom, Hon. Bona Malwal was a man of great conviction and intellect, whose lifelong dedication to the cause of self-determination for South Sudan left a lasting mark on the nation's history. From the early years of struggle, he used his voice and pen to champion the rights and aspirations of the South Sudanese people.

Through various media mouthpieces such as the Vigilante (1965 -1969), the Sudanow (1976 -1978), the Sudan Times (1986 -1989) and the Sudan Democratic Gazette (1989 -2001), and through political platforms such as the Southern Front, the SPLM, and the South Sudan Democratic Forum, among others, Hon. Bona Malwal tirelessly advocated for justice and the liberation of the oppressed. His commitment to these principles often placed him at the center of political debates and controversy, but with integrity, compassion, and intellect attributes, he never deviated.

Hon. Bona Malwal witnessed the realization of the struggle of the people of South Sudan through the 2011 Referendum and the eventual Independence of South Sudan, milestones to which his contributions were indispensable. In his later years, Hon. Bona Malwal chose to retire from active party politics, leaving behind a legacy of resilience, intellect, and patriotic service. His life reminds us that the road to freedom is shaped by the courage and sacrifice of many who dared to believe in a better future.

Hon. Bona Malwal will be remembered for having continuously enlightened and inspired generations of South Sudanese towards independence. His last fundamental contributions are captioned in the recent national dialogue (2017-2020), one of South Sudan's most inclusive participatory nation-building process that clearly identified the problem of South Sudan, and for which he signed its report cover note, alongside fellow iconic historical leaders, namely H.E. Abel Alier and H.E. Angela Beda. May the soul of our elderly statesman and freedom fighter Hon. Bona Malwal Madut Ring rest in eternal peace and may the knowledge that his efforts harnessed continue to shape the destiny of our newly founded nation.

Yours Faithfully,

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